# Travel and Expenses Policy

**Kestrel Pay Ltd**

| Document control | |
|---|---|
| Version | 2.0 |
| Effective from | 1 July 2026 |
| Replaces | Version 1.0 (effective 1 January 2025) |
| Policy owner | Marco Bianchi, Head of People |
| Approved by | Daniel Reyes, Chief Financial Officer |
| Applies to | All employees and contractors of Kestrel Pay in London, Lisbon and Dublin |
| Questions | expenses@kestrelpay.example |

## 1. Purpose

This policy sets out which costs Kestrel Pay pays back when you spend money on company business, the limits that apply, and how to claim. It covers travel, accommodation, meals, client entertainment and small purchases made on behalf of the company.

The policy applies to any cost incurred on or after 1 July 2026. Costs incurred before that date are claimed under version 1.0, even if you submit the claim later.

If something is not covered here, ask your line manager before you spend the money. If your manager is unsure, they should ask the Finance AP team.

## 2. Principles

- Spend company money as carefully as you would spend your own.
- Choose the cheapest option that still gets the job done. Time matters too: a cheaper flight that costs you a day is not cheaper.
- Get approval before you book travel, not after.
- Claim only what you actually spent, once, with the evidence this policy asks for.
- The limits below are maximums, not allowances. If you spend less, claim less.

## 3. Booking travel

Book all flights, rail and hotels through the travel booking portal on the intranet. The portal applies the limits in section 4 and sends the booking to your line manager for approval. Bookings made outside the portal are only reimbursed if the portal could not offer a comparable option, and you must say why in the claim.

Book at least 14 days ahead where you can. Last-minute bookings over the limits need written approval from your head of department.

### 3.1 Rail

Travel standard class. First class is allowed for a single journey of more than 3 hours if you book it at least 7 days ahead and it costs no more than £30 above the standard fare.

### 3.2 Air

Fly economy for any flight under 6 hours. Premium economy is allowed for flights of 6 hours or more with head of department approval. Checked baggage is reimbursed when you travel for 3 nights or more, or when you carry equipment.

### 3.3 Taxis and ride-hailing

Use public transport where it is reasonable. Taxis are reimbursed when you travel after 21:00, when you carry heavy equipment, when no reasonable public transport exists, or when you travel with a client.

### 3.4 Using your own car

Mileage is paid at 45p a mile for the first 10,000 business miles in the tax year and 25p a mile after that. Commuting between home and your usual office is not business mileage. Parking and tolls are reimbursed with a receipt. Fines are never reimbursed.

## 4. Limits

The limits apply per person. Outside the UK, costs in another currency are converted at the rate on the day you incurred them.

| Item | Limit |
|---|---|
| Meals and subsistence | £40 a day |
| Hotel, London | £200 a night |
| Hotel, rest of the UK | £130 a night |
| Hotel, Lisbon or Dublin | €180 a night |
| Hotel, other EU cities | €160 a night |
| Client entertainment | £75 a head, approved in advance |
| Team meals (manager-led) | £30 a head, up to once a quarter |
| Home office equipment | £300 once, in your first 3 months |

### 4.1 Meals and subsistence

You can claim meals when you travel overnight on business, or when you work away from your usual office for more than 10 hours in a day. The daily limit covers breakfast, lunch, dinner and soft drinks.

Alcohol is not reimbursed, except as part of approved client entertainment under section 4.3.

If breakfast is included in your hotel rate, the daily limit stays the same.

### 4.2 Hotels

The nightly limit covers the room and taxes. It does not cover the minibar, room service beyond the meals limit, films, laundry for stays under 5 nights, or late checkout. If you stay with friends or family instead of a hotel, you may claim £25 a night towards a thank-you gift or meal, with a receipt.

For a stay that spans the change of policy, each night is paid at the limit in force on that night.

### 4.3 Client entertainment

Client entertainment needs your head of department's approval before the event. Record every client attendee's name and company in the claim. Gifts and hospitality must also follow the Code of Conduct.

## 5. Receipts

Keep an itemised receipt for every expense above £25. Upload a photo of it to the claim. For expenses of £25 or less you can claim without a receipt, but you must enter the merchant, the date and the business reason.

A card statement or a payment confirmation is not an itemised receipt. If you lose a receipt for an expense above £25, complete the missing receipt declaration in the claim. More than two missing receipt declarations in a year will be raised with your line manager.

## 6. Kestrel expense cards

Employees who travel at least once a month can ask for a Kestrel Accounts expense card. Card spend follows the same limits and receipt rules as personal spend. Match every card transaction to a receipt and a business reason within 30 days of the transaction date. Unmatched transactions over 60 days old may be deducted from your pay, after Finance has contacted you.

Do not use the expense card for personal spending, even if you plan to pay it back.

## 7. Claiming and approval

1. Submit claims through the expenses tool in Kestrel People within 30 days of the date you spent the money. Claims older than 30 days are only paid with head of department approval.
2. Your line manager approves every claim.
3. A claim over £500 also needs your head of department's approval.
4. A claim over £2,000 also needs approval from the Chief Financial Officer.
5. Approvers must not approve their own claims or claims for a trip they took part in. Send those to the next level up.

Claims approved by the 15th of the month are paid with that month's salary. Claims approved after the 15th are paid the following month.

The Finance AP team checks every claim over £500 and a random 10% of the rest. They may ask you for more information before the claim is paid.

## 8. What is not reimbursed

- Travel between home and your usual office
- Fines, penalties and parking tickets
- Upgrades to flights, rail or hotels you booked yourself
- Personal travel insurance (the company policy covers business trips)
- Travel or meals for partners, family or friends
- Alcohol, outside approved client entertainment
- Gym, spa and leisure charges
- Lost or stolen personal items
- Tips above 12.5% of the bill

## 9. Breaches

Claiming money you did not spend, claiming the same cost twice, or splitting a cost to get under an approval threshold or a receipt threshold is a disciplinary matter and may be treated as gross misconduct. Managers who approve claims they know break this policy are also in breach.

## 10. Contacts

- Expenses questions and claim status: Finance AP team, expenses@kestrelpay.example (Grace Adeyemi, Accounts Payable Specialist)
- Policy questions: Marco Bianchi, Head of People
- Approval above £2,000: Daniel Reyes, Chief Financial Officer

## 11. What changed from version 1.0

| Area | Version 1.0 (from 1 January 2025) | Version 2.0 (from 1 July 2026) |
|---|---|---|
| Meals and subsistence | £35 a day | £40 a day |
| Hotel, London | £180 a night | £200 a night |
| Hotel, rest of the UK | £120 a night | £130 a night |
| Hotel, Lisbon or Dublin | €170 a night | €180 a night |
| Hotel, other EU cities | €150 a night | €160 a night |
| Client entertainment | £60 a head | £75 a head |
| Receipts | Itemised receipt for expenses over £50 | Itemised receipt for every expense above £25 |
| Claim deadline | 60 days | 30 days |
| Alcohol with meals | Allowed within the daily limit | Not reimbursed, except client entertainment |
| First class rail | Not reimbursed | Allowed for journeys over 3 hours, booked 7 days ahead, at most £30 above standard |

The hotel and meals limits were raised after the Finance review of 2025 travel spend found that 41% of London hotel bookings went over the £180 limit with approval. The receipt threshold was lowered to meet the audit recommendation of February 2026.